



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

MAR 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for May is

April 20

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

April

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:15 am Education and Fellowship.

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in April

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1 Easter Communion 7a Sunrise Service 8a Breakfast 9a Worship/Organ 10a Egg Hunt etc 11a Worship/Band 7p SAA	2 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance	3 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	4 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	5 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	6 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Movie Night	7 World Health Day 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 10a New Member Class
8 7a Boy Scout Pancake Bkfst 9a Worship/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship/Band 2p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	9 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	10 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Nokomis Prov. Group	11 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	12 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	13 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	14 Childcare Night 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
15 9a Worship/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship/Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	16 Tax Day (Taxes Due) 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts	17 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	18 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6p New Member Class 6:45p Chancel Choir	19 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	20 <i>Mandala Set up</i> Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	21 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 9a Will Party 10a Mandala Carnival 5p Adult game night @Becketwood
22 Earth Day 9a Worship/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship/Band 3:30p Minnehaha Young Families Dinner 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	23 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	24 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	25 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	26 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	27 Arbor Day 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	28 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
29 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	30 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	Notes: Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.				

Worship in April

Easter comes to us on April 1 (worship services at 7:00 a.m., 9:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m.), and then the rest of the Sundays in April fall into the liturgical season of The Sundays of Easter. Often it seems like Easter is the pinnacle of the liturgical year. After Jesus is resurrected, what more is there to say? Well, it turns out, quite a bit. Now that we have the resurrection, what are we supposed to do next? The texts in Easter take us down that road, pointing us in the various ways we are called to live our lives, post-resurrection. We'll begin by honoring the importance of laughter on Holy Humor Sunday, and then follow where the texts take us after that. See you in worship!

1st	"The Gift of Hope"	Mark 16:1-8
	<i>Easter Sunday! Communion; Services at 7, 9, & 11</i>	
8th	Holy Humor Sunday	Proverbs 17:22
15th	"Now What? Witness"	Luke 24:36b-48
22nd	"Now What? Serve"	I John 3:16-22
29th	"Now What? Include"	Acts 8:26-40

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- May 20 – One Service Sunday – Children's Musical
- May 27 – One Service Sunday – Memorial Day Weekend
- June 3 – One Service Sunday – Graduation Sunday
- June 10 – Summer outdoor services begin. Blessing of bikes and bike helmets at both services, potluck picnic following the second service.
- June 18-22 – Music and Drama Camp
- June 20-22 – Vacation Bible School
- July 15—Cowboy Sunday
- July 15-17— Adventure Camp
- July 29-Aug 3—Wilderness Camp

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

April 20

Holy Week at Minnehaha



Palm Sunday – March 25th

Worship at 9 and 11am – Children are invited to join in the Palm Processional, and the Cherub Choir will be singing at both services

Maundy Thursday – March 29th

Join for dinner and an adaptation of the Jewish Seder Meal at 6pm, followed by a communion service commemorating the Last Supper in the Sanctuary.

Good Friday – March 30th

The sanctuary will be opened for contemplation and Stations of the Cross from 9am-5pm, utilizing the artwork of DeGrazia

Tenebrae Service at 7pm. Will include readings, music, silence, and the extinguishing of lights.

Easter Sunday – April 1st

Sunrise Service at 7am; Breakfast served from 8-9am; Worship with organ, choir, Hallelujah Chorus & Children's Choir at 9am; Easter Egg Hunt & Easter Crafts from 10-11am; Worship with band & Children's Choir at 11am

Youth Ministries

Here is a look forward at the next month for our Youth ministries program. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate! All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.

March 31st – Sunrise Service Rehearsal and Pizza dinner: Goes from 4:00-6:00pm. Youth are getting together for our final rehearsal for the Easter Sunrise service. If your youth is participating in the Sunrise service PLEASE have them come to the rehearsal. Rehearsal will be a hour and then we will have a pizza dinner and play some games. There is no cost for the pizza.

April 1st - Easter Sunday: Easter Sunday: Youth run Sunrise service at 7:00am - Please have all youth to MUMC by 6:30 to get ready, Breakfast is being served in the basement at 8am, During the Traditional service at 9am the youth will be hiding the Easter eggs for the Childrens egg hunt, Sunday school festivities including the egg hunt start at 10am, and the Contemporary Worship service is at 11am.

April 1st – No Confirmation Classes: Easter Sunday

April 8th - Youth Night: Nickelodeon Universe! The youth group is going to Nickelodeon Universe for a afternoon of fun and fellowship. We will be leaving the Church at 3pm and back around 6pm. We are expecting a big group and could always use more parent chaperones, if you or your youth would like to attend or you have questions please contact Lani Thompson.

April 15th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be reviewing their Easter Sunrise worship service. The older class will be having a Mentor night and meeting in the 3rd floor Choir room discussing *Noah and the Flood*.

April 22nd – Sunday Morning: Parents of current 5th graders are invited to a special informational meeting with Becky and Lani during the Sunday school hour (10:15-11:00am) to discuss what to expect next year in the Youth program. During this time the 5th graders will be invited up to the 6th and 7th grade Sunday school room to see what their class is like.

April 22nd – Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on Confirmation books. The older class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Choir room discussing *Jonah and the Whale*.

April 29th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be filming the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be discussing *The 10 Commandments & Beatitudes*.

In case Youth Camps are not on your calendar yet here our the dates, if you want more info talk to Lani Thompson.

- *Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 15-17 (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koronis Retreat Center*
- *Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 29-Aug 3rd (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds*

Leilani Thompson, *Director of Youth Ministries*

Children's Ministries

Easter's almost here! We've been waiting for this - making our way through the dark wood during Lent, exploring what gifts there are in fear and doubt and wandering. We've been waiting for this - for life to make its way through the frozen ground, for buds to show on trees, to feel the sun's warmth. We know that all of this waiting is part of the wonder and beauty of life. That the gifts of the dark wood that we examined as part of our Lenten observation are real, that the trees that look dead are about to show us that they are indeed alive, that bulbs underground are preparing to break forth.

We know that we needed this winter, and we know as certainly and wonderfully that we need this spring - that we need Easter.

Each year, we are gifted - through nature as well as through the Easter story - with the incredible truth: God is life and love, and God conquers death and brings us life. We see the gift of life and hope all around us, we see God all around us. Even though it's still a bit muddy and grey, head outside: look for spring's arrival with every sense. Celebrate with your children the miracle of Easter!

As we head into spring, we've got a number of different opportunities for you to join us in! We continue **Wednesday night dinners and programming**, our regular **Sunday morning** schedule, and **Thursday morning playgroup**. Additionally, we have a **Child Care Night/Parent's Night Out** scheduled for April 14th. Children are invited for a fun evening here at Minnehaha (dinner included), while parents get a chance to connect at one of our local restaurants. On April 22nd, families of babies and toddlers are invited for a **Young Families Dinner** here at Minnehaha. Parents of children and youth



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

are invited to a ***Raising Digital Kids Without Having Been One***, a talk with **Galit Breen**, author of *Kindness Wins*, on Wednesday, April 25th. And, people of all ages are invited to join us for an **afternoon/evening adventure at Lebanon Hills**. We'll hike, play, eat, and connect - on Saturday, April 28th. There is information throughout this newsletter and on our website about all of these events.

Additionally, it's certainly time to get set for summer. We offer to great camps here at Minnehaha. For children ages three (and potty-trained) through ten years old, we have **Vacation Bible School from June 20th-22nd**. We'll spend three fun mornings here at Minnehaha, exploring how God is with us through all of life's adventures. Through crafts, science experiments, games, music, stories, and snacks, we'll grow relationships with each other and with God.

For children & youth ages nine through

(Continued on page 7)



**WEDNESDAYS at
MINNEHAHA UMC**

Join us for supper from 5:30-6:30
in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
**PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD
& RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!**

Programming for Kids:
From 6:15-7pm each week, elementary students will
meet to prepare for Children's Sunday in room 208,
preschoolers & kindergartners will have activity time
in room 202 & 204.
**The Minnehaha Adult Choir Rehearses
at 6:45pm in room 310**

The Minnehaha UMC Children's Council invites you to:

RAISING A DIGITAL KID WITHOUT HAVING BEEN ONE with Galit Breen

WHEN: Wednesday, 25th April, from 6:30-7:30pm

WHERE: Minnehaha United Methodist Church, 3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis

WHO: Parents of children & youth

Free child care available



This digital age is not for the faint of heart. From apps to texts to disappearing messages, there is a lot for parents to keep track of! Join us for a round table presentation and Q&A with bestselling author Galit Breen to dig into how our kids are experiencing the online world and we can best help them be safe and wise with their online use.

Galit is the author of *Kindness Wins*, a simple, no-nonsense guide to teaching our kids how to be kind online; the TEDx Talk, "Raising a digital kid without having been one"; the online courses *Boom, Done, Digital Parenting™* and *Raise Your Digital Kid™*; and the Facebook group *The Savvy Parents Club*.

You will leave with:

- The groundwork for your digital parenting
- The 5 things underlying skills your children need to be safe and wise online users
- The 1 thing you can implement today that will make digital parenting easier for you and your kids
- The ability to view the online world through your child's eyes
- The secret thing children are doing online that parents need to be prepared for
- Your most pressing questions answered
- And a FREE digital copy of Galit's book!

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Join us first for our Wednesday Night Dinner
from 5:30 to 6:22pm
\$5/person, \$20/family, 3 & under free
*We'll have a follow-up conversation with Galit
on Wednesday, May 2nd*



Easter Services

Join us for Easter Sunday on April 1. We'll start out with a sunrise service at 7:00 a.m. in the sanctuary. The youth will be leading this worship, and have a great theme planned. The Men's Group will serve breakfast from 8-9, and there is an Easter egg hunt for children from 10-11. At 9:00 is a more traditional service with choir and organ (and the singing of the Hallelujah Chorus), and the 11:00 service features band and vocals. We hope to see you on Easter morning!

"Will Party" Saturday, April 21 at 9:00 am

On Saturday, April 21, starting at 9:00 am with a continental breakfast, Minnehaha UMC will host another "Will Party" event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

The "Will Party" will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Childcare will also be provided upon request. RSVP's not necessary but appreciated so we know about how many will be attending. Questions regarding this event and RSVP's may be directed to Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256.

Minnehaha's Spring Outdoor Adventure

Who: All Ages Welcome
When: Saturday, 28th April
3:30-6pm

Where: Lebanon Hills Park, Jensen Lake Trailhead

**There's access to many hiking trails,
a great playground, and a canoe launch.**
**We'll gather to enjoy a beautiful spring afternoon,
and encourage you to bring a picnic dinner along.**
If weather doesn't cooperate, we'll reschedule.
This info will be on the website/FB Event.

(Continued from page 5)

New Member Classes

We'll be holding two introduction and orientation classes for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining. Please come on either Saturday, April 7 at 10:00 a.m. or Wednesday, April 18 at 6:00 p.m. For the Wednesday evening class, note that we serve a meal at 5:30. You are invited to be our guest at that meal before coming to the class. Just to give us an idea of numbers so we can choose the appropriate size room (and make sure we have enough food), please RSVP to

fourteen, we have **Music & Drama Camp from June 18th-22nd**. During the week, participants will work on putting together all aspects of a musical production: learning lines, songs, and dances, building sets, creating costumes, and props. This year our theme is *Stories of Extraordinary People*. Children between the ages of 6 & 9 can participate in both camps. Please speak directly with Jenia Strom to determine if this would work for your child.

More information & registration for both of these camps is available at our website and at church.

For all of the above - please let me know if you have any questions or concerns. And, if you have other ideas about how we can help your family to grow in faith and connect with our community, please feel free to let me know!

Happy Easter,

Jenia Strom, *Director of Children & Family Ministries*
education@minnehaha.org

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on April 13 for a time of renewal.

STORIES OF EXTRAORDINARY

PEOPLE

MINNEHAHA MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP 2018

**WHEN: MONDAY, JUNE 18-FRIDAY, JUNE 22ND
FROM 8AM - 3PM**

PERFORMANCE: FRIDAY, JUNE 22ND AT 7PM

WHO: KIDS/YOUTH WHO ARE ENTERING 4TH-8TH GRADE

WHERE: MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

3701 E. 30TH STREET, MINNEAPOLIS, MN 55417

COST: \$100/PERSON

**JOIN US FOR A WONDERFUL WEEK. TOGETHER, UNDER THE
DIRECTION OF LOCAL ACTOR, DIRECTOR, & TEACHER, MAUREEN
TREPP, WE'LL TAKE ON ALL ASPECTS OF CREATING AN ORIGINAL
MUSICAL PRODUCTION THAT WILL CELEBRATE EXTRAORDINARY
PEOPLE IN THIS WORLD!**

**REGISTER TODAY AT MINNEHAHA UMC
OR BY VISITING WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG**



*Who's ready for a night out?
Children have a fun night at church.
Parents have a relaxing night out together.
Funds go to support children & youth programs.*

the Minnehaha Children's Council's **Spring Child Care at Minnehaha & Parents' Night Out**

When: Saturday, 10th April from 5-8pm
Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC

Cost:

\$25-1 child

\$35-2 children

\$40-3 children

For children up to 11 years of age

PLEASE RSVP BY March 30th
Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org
or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231

Holy Week Services

Holy Week is observed during the last week of Lent, between Palm Sunday (March 25) and Easter Sunday (April 1). It is traditionally a time to remember Jesus' entry into Jerusalem, his last supper with the disciples, and his arrest, trial and death.

This year, we'll be offering a Maundy Thursday Seder meal in the Fellowship Hall beginning at 6:00 on March 29. We'll be following an adaptation of a Jewish Seder meal, including dinner, and then concluding with a communion service commemorating the Last Supper in the sanctuary. We should be done by 7:30.

We will also have a Good Friday service on March 30. Service. It will also start at 7:00 and will include 14 readings from the gospel of Mark about the events leading up to Jesus' death. It also includes music, silence, and the extinguishing of lights.

In addition, the sanctuary will be open on Good Friday between 9:00 and 5:00 for anyone who would like to engage in some silent contemplation. There is a centuries-old tradition of observing Stations of the Cross with words or artwork signifying important stops on Jesus' journey to the cross. Utilizing artwork by DeGrazia, we will have stations set up in the sanctuary.

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the



Minnehaha Young Families Spring Dinner

Who: Babies & toddlers & their families

When: Sunday, 22nd April, 4:30-6pm

Where: Minnehaha Fellowship Hall

Join us for a chance to play, to connect, to be in community with other young families. Minnehaha Children's Council will provide dinner, just come for a relaxing evening together.

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at
education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231

www.minnehaha.org



Minnehaha United Methodist Women's Annual SPRING PLANT SALE

HANGING BASKETS – \$25.00



- Non-Stop Begonias (Shade)
- Single Impatiens (Shade)
- New Guinea Impatiens (Shade)
- Zonal Geraniums (Sun)
- Ivy Geraniums (Sun)
- Fuschia (Semi-Sun)

PATIO POTS – \$33.00



- Zonal Geranium (Sun)

For more information, contact:
Kim Kanuit @ 612-860-0256

Pre-paid orders taken between services in the Fellowship Hall on Sunday, April 8, 15, 22 & 29.

Ready for pickup on Sunday, May 6 – one week before Mother's Day!

Proceeds benefit United Methodist Women's Missions

Rally to End Racism

In honor of the 50th anniversary of the assassination of Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., there will be a Rally to End Racism at the National Mall in Washington, DC on Wednesday, April 4. The President of the United Methodist Council of Bishops, who is also our bishop, Bruce Ough, will officially kick off the rally on Tuesday, April 3 at 2:00 p.m. at the United Methodist Building. The Wisconsin Council of Churches is sponsoring a number of buses to take people to the rally, leaving on April 3 and returning on April 5. The cost for a bus is \$250, and registrations are accepted until buses are full. The Minnesota Council of Churches is helping to coordinate MN folk who want to catch a bus (buses leave from Eau Claire, Appleton, Madison, and Milwaukee), so if you are interested or want more information, contact julia.hobart@mncchurches.org or register directly with the Wisconsin Council of Churches (you can find them through any search engine). Just let them know that you are from Minnesota – they want to keep track of how many bus riders come from MN.

First Friday Films

Do you find yourself shouting advice to characters during a movie? Nudging your neighbor with an elbow during critical scenes? Wishing you had someone to talk to about the movie you just watched? Then you are in luck! Come to the church on the first Friday of the month at 7:00 and settle in to watch a movie with fellow Minnehaha-ians. Bring your own beverage and snacks, and feel free to bring a friend as well. After the credits roll, you'll have an opportunity to share your "aha" moments, the things you liked or disliked, or anything else the movie prompted in you.

This month, we'll watch *Invictus*. Released in 2009, the film takes place in South Africa, just after Nelson Mandela has been elected president and apartheid is being dismantled. It is about the national rugby team, the *Springboks*, and how Mandela uses their entry in the 1995 Rugby World Cup, being held in South Africa, to promote national unity. We look forward to seeing you on Friday, April 6 at 7:00 in Room 310.

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of United Methodist beliefs. In April we will be gathering on April 12.

ROLLING RIVER RAMPAGE

Minnehaha UMC's Vacation Bible School 2018

When: Wednesday, June 20th - Friday, June 22nd
from 9-11:30am *Extended Childcare Available*
Who: Children who are 3 (and potty-trained) - 10 years old
Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Cost: \$25/child or \$40/family
Register today at Minnehaha UMC or online at www.minnehaha.org.

Experience the ride of a lifetime! At Minnehaha, we'll spend these three mornings connecting with old friends and new. We'll learn all about how God is present in our lives. We'll do crafts, play games, conduct science experiments, create snacks, hear stories, sing songs, and more. Invite your friends and join us for *Rolling River Rampage!*

*When you pass through the waters,
I will be with you.*

-Isaiah 43:2



Minnehaha Top the Tater Potluck & Game Night

Hosted by Todd & Tracy Gulliver

For MUMC adults of all ages

When: Saturday, April 21,
from 5-9pm

Where: Becketwood's Windsor
Room (4300 W. River Pkwy, Mpls)



Join us for food, fun and conversation at a "Top the Tater" potluck. Bring your favorite potato toppings, an appetizer, side dish, beverage and/or a dessert to share and prepare to design a delectable spud masterpiece.
Baked potatoes will be provided.

To RSVP, email Tracy Gulliver at tracygulliver@gmail.com or call 651-274-1657

Holy Humor Sunday

Laughter is good for the body and the soul, so we're going to load up on it on Sunday, April 8. Come to worship expecting funny music and lots of jokes. Feel free to participate in our celebration of joy and humor by dressing up in a funny way or making a pun out of your outfit. Invite a friend to join in the laughter!



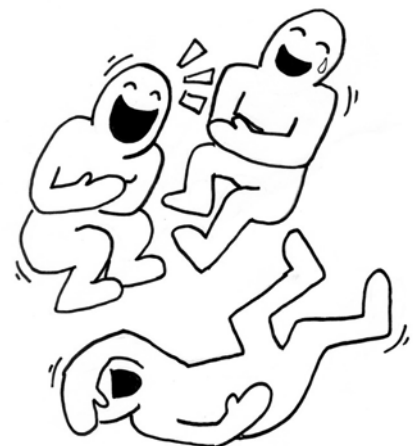
Laughter

My maternal grandfather was known for his sense of humor. When he was alive, he would regale us with stories of the practical jokes he played on his friends in college. He loved a good pun, stating that the value of the pun could be calculated by how loudly the listener would groan. And there is a famous family story about his sister-in-law entrusting him with the keys to her car on her wedding day, but making him promise not to use the keys to do anything to her car. He promptly took the keys to the hardware store, made a copy, and then used the copy of the key to get into her car, put limburger cheese over the air intake valve, and tie sausages to the exhaust. His sense of humor was passed down to his four daughters, and my mother and all my aunts passed along to us the art of telling shaggy dog stories, quirky jokes, puns, and practical jokes.

Researchers have now confirmed what many of us already knew – laughing regularly is good for you. Laughing can reduce your stress level, lowering blood pressure and filling your body with endorphins. It also relaxes your muscles and boosts your immune system. Thankfully, I didn't have to begin practicing laughter, I was already doing it. As many of you know, I gather regularly with a group of clergywomen. We've been meeting monthly for almost 25 years. And while we do share best practices with each other, seek each other's advice, and trade sermon series ideas, we also laugh. A lot. When we first started gathering, we would often tell our server at the end of our meal that we all shared a job, and then asked them to guess it. We would even give them multiple choice options. Pastors was never a choice our server made. Dental hygienist was the most frequently chosen answer. Apparently, clergy have a reputation for being serious (well, and maybe also being male). And our lunches were rarely serious! Even if we had moments of serious conversation, our laughter at our own foibles and the general life of a congregation would cause us to laugh, sometimes so loudly that other people in the restaurant would turn to stare at us.

We are past the season of Lent (or depending on the timing of this newsletter, we are about to be). Whatever you did for Lent, the time is coming to a close. How about a new practice this year? Take up something for Easter. Something that is life-giving. Something that is good for your mind, your body, and your soul. Pick up the practice of laughter. Make sure that you do things regularly that bring you joy, but also be sure to laugh. Laugh at a video or a movie, laugh at a 3rd grader joke, laugh at the antics of your pets or the squirrels outside your window. Have someone tell you jokes, or read a joke book. Read comics that tickle your funny bone, and share them with others. Celebrate the gift of joy from the very God who created us with a funny bone and a fine sense of humor.

In joy,
Becky





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Easter at Minnehaha UMC

7am: Sunrise Service led by the Minnehaha Youth

8-9am: Easter Breakfast served by the Minnehaha Men's Group

9am: Worship with the Adult Choir, Children's Choir, & join the Hallelujah Chorus

10am-11am: Easter Egg Hunt, Flower Making & Easter Crafts

11am: Worship with the Band & Children's Choir

"He has been raised; he is not here!" Mark 16:6

